SmoothieVend®

MARKETING PLAN

SmoothieVend®

Goodness at your Fingertips

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EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Performance Foodgroup (PFG) is a multimillion dollar company encompassing three divisions: Performance Foodservice, Vistar and PFG Customized. Each division meets the needs of a unique group of customers and continues to evolve as the industry grows and changes. Delivering candy, snacks, hot and cold beverages across all 50 states, Vistar is an innovative leader that combines knowledge and experience with a focus on staying ahead of the industry trends. The company is constantly seeking out new products and finding new, innovative ways to expand the markets it serves. To that end, Vistar has developed *SmoothieVend*® machines. This brand which will meet the evolving demands of today's health-conscious consumer by providing customizable, nutritious smoothies and frozen beverages through fully automated vending machines located in health and fitness studios.

SmoothieVend® will be available in 50 fitness centers and health clubs in Miami, Florida. By focusing on a warm weather market, consumers will be more likely to purchase a frozen smoothie year-round and may also be focused on physical fitness for a greater part of the year. *SmoothieVend*® will provide a wide variety of customizable beverages - the number of drink combinations with just the basic ingredients listed on the *SmoothieVend*® menu number in the hundreds of thousands! Because of this variety of permutations of product, the cost will vary within the range of $2.00 - $6.00. Brand awareness will be achieved throughout the target market with social media campaigns, print advertising, and public relations events like "Yoga on the Beach with *SmoothieVend*®." *SmoothieVend*® products will offer high quality, convenient and delicious beverages at a fair price to ensure people do not have an excuse when it comes to maintaining a healthy lifestyle and becoming a better version of themselves.

INDUSTRY ANALYSIS

American consumers have been making conscious efforts to life more healthfully for the past several decades, supported by the steady growth of the health food industry over past 15 years. In

particular, the health drink industry is in one the most lucrative stages of its life cycle. A Mintel market research report entitled “Made to Order Smoothies and Shakes,” highlights the growing “Beverage Bar” category that includes a variety of made to order beverage companies and locations. This market segment has grown from $34 billion in 2009 up to $41 billion in 2014, with a total expected value of $50 billion by 2019.

While current statistics regarding Americans’ health show that about 155 million citizens are overweight or obese, consumers have made strides in actively leading a healthier lifestyle through efforts including an increase in gym memberships, yoga classes, outdoor sports, low fat and low carb food, etc. Healthy smoothies fit well into this type of lifestyle. Moreover, younger demographics are visiting smoothie shops and bars with a higher frequency than previous generations. Americans are trying to find new and exciting ways to incorporate fruits and vegetables into their diets, and smoothies and shakes are just one way this is accomplished.

Consumers are adapting to smoothies for various reasons. Whether a healthy snack replacement, energy replenishment post-workout, or meal replacement, smoothies are easy to eat on the go, which pairs well with the ever-increasing pace of life today. The biggest advantage that smoothies have over competitive beverages is that they are highly customizable. Smoothies can feature various bases and flavors. They can be mixed and matched with a variety of fresh ingredients such as nuts, greens, herbs, fruits, and vitamin or mineral supplements.

Though availability of fruits and vegetables to the consumers means making smoothies at home is always an option, research suggests that many people prefer to purchase a customized smoothie over making one at home, whether because of limited access to ingredients at home, the convenience of the service, or taste preference. As more and more people are using smoothies as a source of energy, a unique proposition of having smoothie bars inside gyms and health clubs has flourished. Many upscale gyms and

health clubs have adopted the in-store smoothie bar. The biggest challenge fitness centers face when installing a smoothie bar is the high initial overhead cost which can be upwards of $50,000 to install the space: plumbing, counters, blenders, refrigeration, seating, etc. This excludes the recurring cost of stocking produce, protein and other supplements as well as wastage. Additionally, this cost does not include staffing of the beverage bar.

Beverage bars are a high growth industry with its own share of pain points including space, staffing, and short- and long-term business costs. Vistar possesses the technology to address these issues with a customizable smoothie vending machine to deliver the benefits of an in-house smoothie bar without many of these associated issues.

ENVIRONMENTAL ANALYSIS

Gaining an understanding on the impact of external influences on a product concept is imperative and resourceful when making decisions on market strategy elements. The *SmoothieVend®* concept will be a one-of-a-kind product in the juice and smoothie bar industry, as well as the healthy vending machine business. As a result, environmental factors will be of a major concern, specifically regulatory, economic, social, and technological.

SmoothieVend® machines will be regulated by the applicable state's Department of Health (DOH) and must be inspected as food establishments. Vistar is committed to the health of customers and will ensure that the state's DOH will inspect the machines annually. This will ensure the frozen fruits and vegetables are kept at appropriate temperatures to safeguard consumer safety. The nutritional information of each beverage and component will be displayed on each of the *SmoothieVend®* machines so consumers can make the best choices for themselves. These factors will be crucial and must be considered while formulating the smoothie mixes that will satisfy and meet the needs of customers.

The location of the *SmoothieVend*® will determine the economic factors of influence. The *SmoothieVend*® will be available in the United States, and the first launch will occur in 50 health clubs throughout the city of Miami, Florida. Florida state tax law states that, "food products prepared and sold for immediate consumption…are taxable." As such, Miami-Dade County sales tax of 7% will be applied to all sales of *SmoothieVend*® beverages; the sale of a smoothie totaling $5.50 will be sold at a total price of $5.89. Each county and state Vistar expands the service into will have its own tax policy, and the influence this will have on the beverage sales at each machine will vary. If Vistar chooses to expand the machines into other countries, tax policies and other market and industry factors of each locale will be considered.

Social factors that affect the *SmoothieVend*® include consumer attitudes and buying patterns, the growth of its target demographics, and any health trends that might be popular at a certain time. The growing interest among consumers in healthful eating habits and active lifestyles will certainly influence the popularity of the *SmoothieVend*® and will allow the marketing strategy to be tailored to work with these factors.

Technologically, the methods of producing the smoothies with the *SmoothieVend*® will be innovative and allow the consumer to be in control of the product they desire. *SmoothieVend*® will use at least 50% post-consumer recycled plastic in its drink cups and straws to minimize negative environmental impact. Advances in the manufacturing of the packaging will also add to the innovation of the *SmoothieVend*®.

The external dynamics considered here will be used to inform the placement, sales and expansion of *SmoothieVend*® machines. These environmental dynamics will vary in each market, and the full breadth of the influence of each will only be fully understood after placement of the machines in each market. By elucidating the influences and effects in this plan, Vistar is best prepared to capitalize on the strengths

and opportunities of the business, as well as mitigate the weaknesses of and threats to *SmoothieVend*® markets. (See "Appendix A" for SWOT analysis of *SmoothieVend*®.)

COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

DIRECT COMPETITORS

When considering a smoothie or post-workout supplementary drink, consumers have many choices from which to select. Many direct competitors exist that will compete with *SmoothieVend*®. The strongest direct competitor is the customizable beverage bar that currently exists in many gyms and health clubs, such as RetroBlends, the proprietary smoothie bar located inside RetroFitness gyms. This amenity provides smoothies and beverages that consumers can tailor to their taste and pre- or post-workout recovery needs. The location is also more convenient than leaving and traveling to another location to purchase a smoothie or other beverage for use before or after a workout. Customized smoothies purchased within a fitness club will typically run a consumer anywhere from $4-$8 depending on size, protein content, and supplements that may be added to the drink. At other direct competitors, which include customizable smoothie and juice chains like Jamba Juice, Smoothie King, Planet Smoothie, Freshii, and various local or regional stores, consumers can expect the cost of a drink to be in this range as well. These chains typically offer a larger variety of drink options than the beverage bar located within health clubs because the focus of customers coming to these locations is not exclusively a fitness-related beverage experience. Consumers going to a Jamba Juice may be looking for a fruit smoothie simply because they are craving one on a hot summer day, or a parent might like to treat their child to a milkshake but prefer the healthier options afforded them at a smoothie chain over, say, a sugary McDonald's or Dairy Queen milkshake.

INDIRECT COMPETITORS

Products which also compete for consumers attention and dollars within the fitness- and health-conscious crowd are other sports nutrition and nutraceutical products. These include prepackaged protein drinks, shakes, snack bars, and even plain or flavored milks tailored to the pre- and post-exercise experience. Energy drinks take the form of off-the-shelf brands like Red Bull, Monster and Rockstar, to the more specific preworkout blends like C4 and MaxOut, but are typically consumed prior to a workout session. Specific to the post-workout experience, consumers may reach for a prepackaged beverage option or opt for a scoop of protein powder from a brand such as Xtend, AminoLean or post-gym. These powders typically come in very large containers that are not easily transported to the gym for use after a workout. Some consumers may take the extra step to portion out what is needed in a small reusable plastic container or plastic sealable snack bag. This option is less convenient but a cost savings for the consumer. Additionally, these protein powders may not always contain the exact blend of protein content and supplements the consumer wishes to enjoy after their workout. Dairy milk is a popular drink following a workout as it is a good source of natural protein with 16 ounces of nonfat milk containing approximately 15 grams of the nutrient. However, many people do not wish to consume dairy following exercise as it can upset the stomach. It is, however, typically a less expensive beverage than a protein powder based blend.

MARKETING STRATEGY: TARGET MARKET AND MARKETING MIX

TARGET MARKET

Joe and Jane Gymgoer are health-conscious consumers that prioritize their health. Joe and Jane can fall into any age category, and often look for a snack or beverage option following a workout that will provide nutrition, taste and convenience at an appropriate price point. After a strong workout, Joe and Jane Gymgoer want a healthful and customizable option to quell their hunger and aid in muscle recovery. While protein bars and snacks are convenient enough, they often contain low quality proteins, fillers, or

other ingredients that consumers like Joe and Jane find undesirable. These customers are going to a gym to improve their physical and mental well-being; therefore, they will not want a snack or beverage after a great sweat session that contains anything less than high-quality ingredients. In an online survey of 55 respondents, the most frequently identified reason for purchasing a customizable beverage was protein and supplement content to aid in muscle recovery, followed by taste. Following a workout, consumers purchasing these beverages will expect quality protein and supplements. *SmoothieVend®* will exceed these expectations with organic whey protein powders and superior enhancements.

Consumers will appreciate the novelty of the *SmoothieVend®* experience as it couples a known product, the customizable smoothie, with a new and innovative way to prepare the product. This will be seen as not only exciting, but viewed as a better alternative to other made-to-order smoothies, because consumers tend to view products that are newer as better. The buying habits of the typical gymgoer will vary when it comes to these customizable beverages, but as is the case with consumer purchasing habits, when something is enjoyable we tend to purchase more of it and regularly. Personal experience has shown me that I am likely to purchase a smoothie from my gym half or more of the times I workout provided that the price point is right, the taste and texture are enjoyable, and the beverage is low in or free of, added sugar.

PRODUCT

SmoothieVend® is a completely unique beverage experience for the health-conscious consumer looking for a post-workout supplementary drink, a meal replacement, or a snack before the next main meal. *SmoothieVend®* marries the convenience of a vending machine with the creativity of tailoring a beverage to one's own tastes and desires. The product is differentiated well from competitors, as no health club in the market today offers a fully automated customizable beverage service. If a gym offers this service, it must be staffed by personnel at the location. Additionally, the overhead to install and maintain

this service creates a high cost for the health club, costs which could be spent on equipment, additional trainers, staffing needs, or other improvements. *SmoothieVend®* responds to the needs of both the consumer and the gym by meeting the wants of the customer and allowing the gym to operate in a more efficient, cost-saving manner.

With *SmoothieVend®*, Vistar is not just selling customers a vending machine snack for easy and quick consumption. The unique selling proposition of *SmoothieVend®* is the ability for health-conscious consumers to creatively customize a quality beverage of their choosing that not only tastes great but also provides the consumer satisfaction knowing that the muscle recovery and post-exercise benefits they are receiving will taste great, be of high quality, and provide good value for the cost. All *SmoothieVend®* smoothies contain real, organic frozen fruit, are free of added sugars, and all dairy milk is free of any antibiotics or growth hormones.

All *SmoothieVend®* machines will provide plastic cups made from at least 50% recycled materials for each beverage and include a straw. Consumers will also have the option to use their own refillable travel mug in which to enjoy their smoothies. After the blending process is complete inside the machine, the consumer will select if they want the beverage to be poured into the machine's own cup, or if they would like it dispensed into their own container. Additionally, the machine will use an infrared beam to sense the size of the container - if it is too small, the machine will notify the customer and will fill a plastic tumbler inside the machine instead.

SmoothieVend® machines will provide seasonally relevant ingredients based on the time of year, giving customers the freshest and highest quality fruits. For example, when mangoes and peaches are in season in mid-summer, *SmoothieVend®* will offer *The Mango Tango*, a wholesome blend of fresh mangoes, succulent peaches, and vanilla protein powder. In the fall, a cinnamon coffee flavored protein blend will be made available along with pumpkin for *The #PSL* (Pumpkin Spice Latte smoothie). This

variety will engage customers to continue to visit the *SmoothieVend*® machine to see what changes have been made to the menu selection and excited to try new varieties.

The *SmoothieVend*® marketing strategy will be concentrated to gyms and boutique health clubs where the product can cater to the fitness minded consumer. This will allow Performance Food Group's Vistar division to focus on a specialized market set in order to meet the needs of a well-defined target audience. As the brand gains traction and becomes a more popular brand, expanding into other health clubs and markets, *SmoothieVend*® will also expand to a broader target population. We see the *SmoothieVend*® machines as a viable and healthful option for people on the go. From schools and corporate cafeterias to convenience stores and airport terminals, *SmoothieVend*® will provide a convenient, quick, and customizable solution for the consumer looking for this type of option for a snack or meal replacement.

PLACE

Many of today's health clubs have additional services on site for customers, such as customizable smoothie and juice bars. This service is great for customers either before a workout to boost energy, or afterwards to enhance muscle recovery with a beverage that contains important ingredients like protein, glutamine, branch-chain amino acids and other supplements that help support the recovery and growth of muscles.

The startup and overhead costs of a customizable beverage bar can be extremely burdensome to the gym. If a gym is installing a beverage bar that will use fresh fruits and vegetables, the costs can average $50,000 or more. This is because the location will require high quality refrigerators and freezers, plumbing, countertops, storage, high-capacity blenders, and seating as the smoothie bar tends to become a social gathering spot for gym goers either before or after a workout or fitness class.

SmoothieVend® will first become available at 50 health clubs in Miami, Florida. It will be available in fitness centers such as Equinox, LA Fitness, and 24 Hour Fitness. In addition, it will also be available in specialized health clubs like Soulcyle cycling studios and boxing clubs. By focusing on a warm weather market, consumers will be more likely to purchase a frozen smoothie year-round and may also be focused on physical fitness for a greater part of the year. Additionally, by targeting a diverse metropolitan area like Miami, and varying the types of health clubs in which the machines are placed, Vistar will be able to cater to the desires of a varied demographic and inform future expansions into the most profitable gyms and markets.

SmoothieVend® products are not only great for those that want healthy refreshment after the gym, but can also serve as a meal replacement and healthy alternative to processed snacks. Therefore, as the lifecycle of *SmoothieVend*® progresses, the machines will be installed in places of mass transit, schools, hospitals and corporate offices. This will allow the product to reach larger markets, and provide many other on-the-go or time crunched consumers a convenient and healthful meal or snack option.

PRICING

SmoothieVend® will provide a wide variety of customizable beverages - the number of drink combinations with just the basic ingredients listed on the *SmoothieVend*® menu number in the hundreds of thousands (see Appendix C)! Because of this variety of permutations of product, the cost will vary within the range of $3.00 - $6.00.

The cost to operate *SmoothieVend*® machines includes: rented space in each fitness center, cost of organic frozen fruits, supplements, delivery of items, maintenance of the machines, and power to the device. A market research survey performed by Vistar found that the most frequent reason for not purchasing a smoothie was cost. Additionally, it was found that the aspects that most attract customers are the taste of smoothies, the addition of protein or other supplements to the drinks, and the convenience

factor of purchasing a smoothie immediately after a workout. *SmoothieVend®* will reduce the cost of a fully blended smoothie by streamlining this service and will attract customers through a combination of reasonable cost, taste, convenience, and protein and supplement content. Breaking down the costs necessary to make a smoothie, each smoothie will start at a base price of $2.00. This base price includes a beverage made of milk or water and a protein powder. The cost of each additional fruit serving a customer wishes to include in their smoothie is $0.25. Vistar can keep the cost to the consumer low as the organic frozen fruits will be sourced directly from Performance Food Group's division of PFG Foodservice. Supplements will be priced at $0.75 for each individual addition, including the Amazing Grass® vegetable supplement. With these options, a customer will pay approximately $2.00 - $5.00 for a fully customized drink.

In addition to consumers' ability to create their own beverage combinations, *SmoothieVend®* will include predetermined menu options for particular needs. These menu items will cater to a variety of desires, from the consumer looking for a quick and delicious milk and fruit only smoothie as a meal replacement or snack, to the gym goer that just completed their Workout of the Day looking for a high protein, nutritious beverage to help with muscle growth and recovery. These options will be priced between $4.00 and $6.00. Making *SmoothieVend®* products affordable will generate interest in the beverages, as they will not be cost-prohibitive, and create a customer base interested in trying the product. Additionally, placement in fitness centers will allow Vistar to have ready access to health-conscious consumers and provide a convenience to these patrons. Each *SmoothieVend®* can be blended in 30-60 seconds, which will keep the wait time for product low and enhance the convenience of the service.

The perceived high cost of eating a healthful and wholesome diet is a deterrent for many to pursue and maintain a healthier lifestyle. By offering *SmoothieVend®* beverages at competitive prices, consumers

will no longer be deterred to try this service because of cost, nor will they be swayed by having a long wait time or slow-moving staff to preparing the beverages.

PROMOTION

At launch, *SmoothieVend*® will offer a "Free Smoothie Day" for gym goers where each person entering the gym will be given a coupon to feed into the machine for one free beverage of their choosing. Prior to this event, each gym will receive a kit of promotional materials and items to use as giveaways for customers. The kit will include the coupons for free smoothies, T-shirts, hats and refillable travel mugs so customers can also be environmentally conscious and not have to rely on plastic cups provided by the machines. Additionally, *SmoothieVend*® will partner with fitness centers and health clubs to offer beverage packages as a part of membership plans.

ADVERTISING & PUBLIC RELATIONS

Vistar will utilize a multi-phase advertising strategy for *SmoothieVend*®. The first phase will be targeted social media, print and digital advertisements at target rich locations. The second phase will include direct marketing towards fitness club members at each location where *SmoothieVend*® machines are located. Social media ads will focus on showing our audience the journey ingredients go through before reaching the vending machine thus strengthening the values of freshness and healthy foods. The company will shoot a YouTube video showing the insides of the vending machines, showing how the smoothies are made, creating more buzz and excitement.

The prints and digital ads would be focusing on encouraging people to drop their sugary drinks and consider the healthier alternative.

There would be a separate advertising plans for the gym and health studio owners. The brand would have marketing reps talk with the owners, explain them the product and also educate them about how having customizable smoothie machine will increase the overall value of the gym.

The Public Relations would be largely focused on spreading awareness regarding the benefits of healthy living and work and personal life balance. One activity that *SmoothieVend*® proposes is a free yoga session at various beaches in Miami. At this session, people would be educated regarding the benefits of a healthy lifestyle. They will also be introduced to Smoothie Vend products.

INTERNET

Social media is very important in today's world when it comes to raising brand awareness. Prior to launch through free sampling events, and throughout the first year, Vistar will roll out a social media campaign encouraging consumers to record their first sip of a smoothie from *SmoothieVend*® and give their instant reactions and testimonials. The hashtag, "#MyFirstSip," will be used to tag the post on Instagram, Facebook, Snapchat, etc. to share these experiences. This will increase brand awareness and generate a discussion about the product among the masses. The brand also plans to make custom Snapchat Filters promoting the product.

Social media influencers play a very important role in today's world through promotion of products and services in sponsored and unsponsored posts. They have the ability to drive a significant portion of users towards a certain brand, product, or service. In a survey conducted in 2017 by market research firm Collective Bias of 14,000 millennial consumers, it was found that 70% of these customers are influenced by the recommendations of their peers in buying decisions. This influence includes social media posts and promotions from influencers the consumers perceive as peers. Of the traditional major marketing channels, digital ads have influence over just 4.5% of the market, while print advertisements and television commercials influence 4.7% and 7.4% of the consumer segment. The brand will partner with various famous health & fitness social media influencers and daily vloggers, and ask them to introduce the product to their audience.

SmoothieVend® will also create brand specific social media accounts on all relevant social media sites (e.g. Instagram, Twitter, Facebook, Snapchat, YouTube) to increase the brand presence. These accounts would regularly post health & fitness related materials and will be the brands mouthpiece or preferred method of communication. To keep the followers engaged these accounts will hold fun contests and giveaways regularly.

GOALS & PROJECTIONS

GOALS

SmoothieVend® has set demonstrable goals for its brand progression. After the fitness industry targets are met, the brand will work to penetrate other lucrative target markets in several phases. The first phase will address secondary schools, colleges and universities where *SmoothieVend*® machines will serve as a healthier alternative to processed, unhealthy snacks and other prepackaged school lunch products. *SmoothieVend*® can also can effectively compete in other markets where convenience is a priority. The second phase of expansion will see *SmoothieVend*® machines in places of mass transit, including airports, train stations and bus stations where convenient, healthy snack and meal options are often at a minimum. Following this, *SmoothieVend*® will focus its expansions into other profitable markets such as corporate offices, amusement parks, and public gathering places like parks. This plan gives the *SmoothieVend*® brand an innovative and profitable development plan to both increase revenue as well as balance potential changing consumer buying habits in each of its market segments.

PROJECTIONS

The projected expenses for the first year of *SmoothieVend*® total approximately $1 million. The start-up cost will be approximately $750,000, which includes the price of the vending machines, transporting the machines, smoothie ingredients, promotional and advertising campaigns, and health permits. all promotions and advertisement campaigns. The operating and maintenance cost for this year

will be approximately $250,000. This includes restocking ingredients and conducting necessary maintenance for the machines.

As a result of our first-year costs, we believe that *SmoothieVend*® will not generate any revenue. However, we are confident that every year thereafter, *SmoothieVend*® will be a profitable brand for Vistar, generating revenues of $1.5 to $2 million annually. The innovation of *SmoothieVend*® machines and We are confident that our marketing strategy and will lead our brand great levels of success and cause for an improvement of many people's lives.

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APPENDICES

APPENDIX A

SWOT Analysis

STRENGTHS	WEAKNESSES
• Customer satisfaction - good brand equity among potential customers through Performance Food Group • Strong distribution network - PFG built a reliable network to reach potential market • Performance in new market - brand reputation of PFG will help *SmoothieVend* ® gain popularity • Low barriers to entry in the juice and smoothie industry	• Customers may see it as a marketing gimmick that promotes healthy drinks • Cost of the smoothie • Fresh fruits/vegetables will be expensive • Maintaining and restocking all machines will be costly • Competition with established brands like Jamba Juice and Smoothie King
OPPORTUNITIES	**THREATS**
• New product gives PFG a chance to use differentiated pricing strategy • Decreasing cost of transportation due to lower shipping prices can bring down cost of product • Consumers gaining more health awareness • Chance for PFG to use *SmoothieVend*® to benefit	• High price of the products detrimental to acceptance of the smoothies • Intense competition from other providers of smoothies • Bigger companies may buy out smaller companies • Changing consumer preference due to changing interests

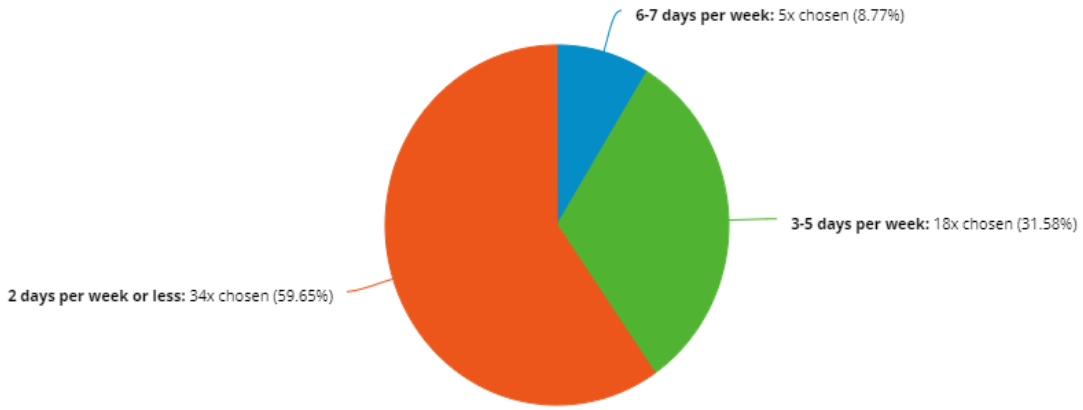
APPENDIX B

SmoothieVend® **Market Research Survey & Results** (conducted online using Survey Hero)

1. How often to you go to a health or fitness club to exercise?
   a. 6-7 days per week
   b. 3-5 days per week
   c. 2 days per week or less

1. How often to you go to a health or fitness club to exercise?

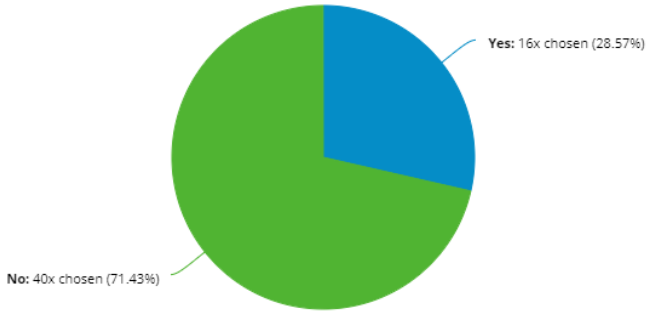
Number of responses: 57



2. Does your health club have a smoothie or juice bar where you can purchase customized beverages?
   a. Yes
   b. No

2. Does your health club have a smoothie or juice bar where you can purchase customized beverages? (If no, skip to question 10)

Number of responses: 56



3. How often do you purchase a customized beverage at your gym's smoothie bar?

a. 100% of the time I workout
b. 75% of the time I workout
c. 50% of the time I workout
d. 25% of the time I workout
e. Never

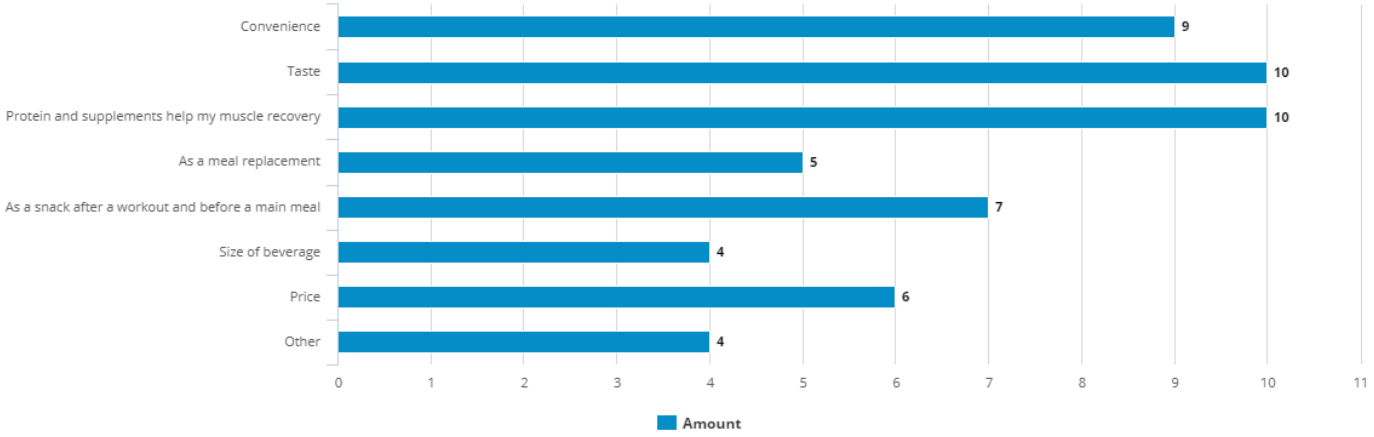
3. How often do you purchase a customized beverage at your gym's smoothie bar?

Number of responses: 29

4. If you purchase a beverage 50% of the time or more, what aspects of the amenity do you like? *Check all that apply*
   a. Convenience
   b. Taste
   c. Protein and supplements help my muscle recovery
   d. As a meal replacement
   e. As a snack after a workout and before a main meal
   f. Size of beverage
   g. Price
   h. Something else _____

4. If you purchase a beverage when you workout, what aspect(s) of the amenity do you like?

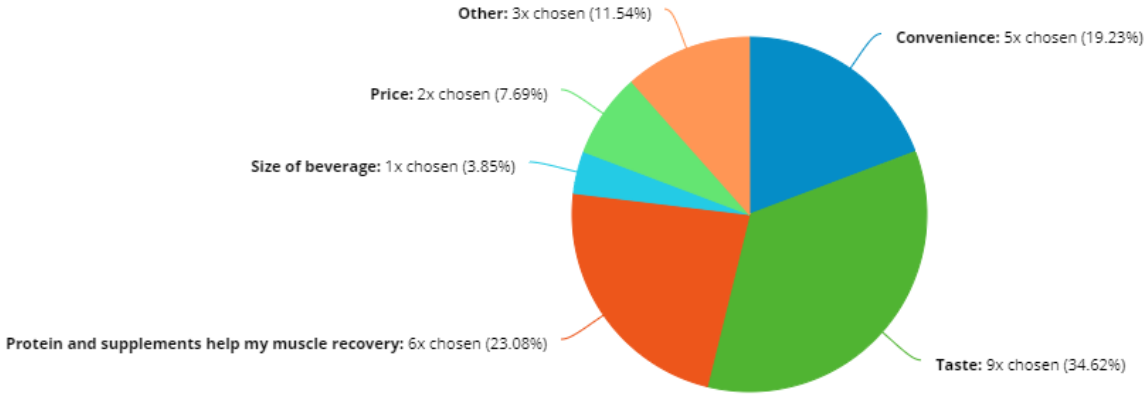
Number of responses: 27



5. What one aspect of the smoothie bar experience is most important to you?
   a. Convenience
   b. Taste
   c. Protein and supplements help my muscle recovery
   d. As a meal replacement
   e. As a snack after a workout and before a main meal
   f. Size of beverage
   g. Price
   h. Something else _____

5. What one aspect of the smoothie bar experience is most important to you?

Number of responses: 26

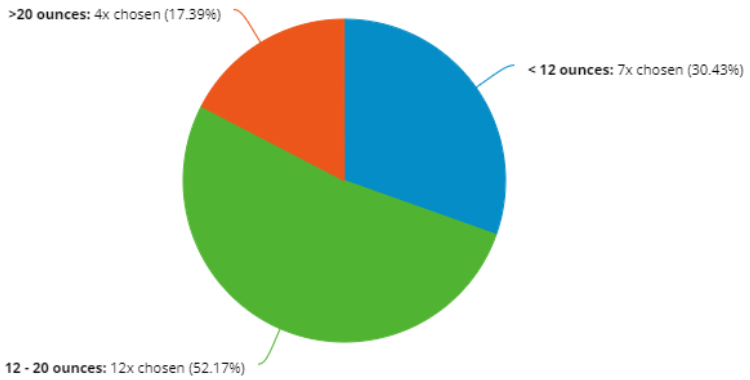


6. What size smoothie or customized beverage do you typically purchase?

a. <12 ounces
b. 12-20 ounces
c. >20 ounces

6. What size smoothie or customized beverage do you typically purchase?

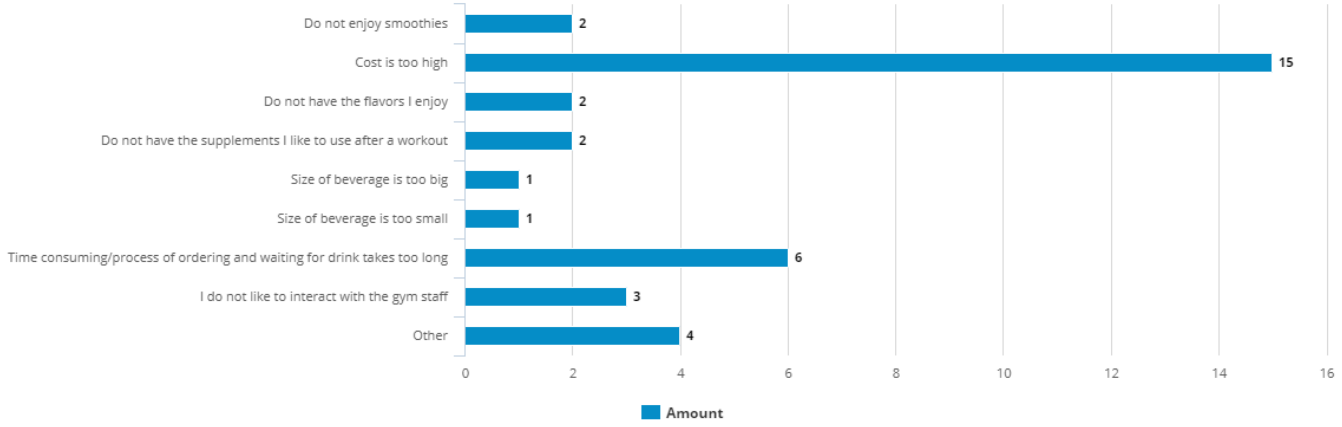
Number of responses: 23



7. If you purchase a beverage less than 50% of the time, what is/are the reasons for not purchasing more frequently?
   Check all that apply
   a. Do not enjoy smoothies
   b. Cost is too high
   c. Do not have the flavors I enjoy
   d. Do not have the supplements I like to use after a workout
   e. Size of beverage is too big
   f. Size of beverage is too small
   g. Time consuming/process of ordering and waiting for drink takes too long
   h. I do not like to interact with the gym staff

7. If you purchase a beverage less than 50% of the time, what is/are the reasons for not purchasing more frequently?Only answer if your response to Question #3 was 50% or 25% of the time you workout.

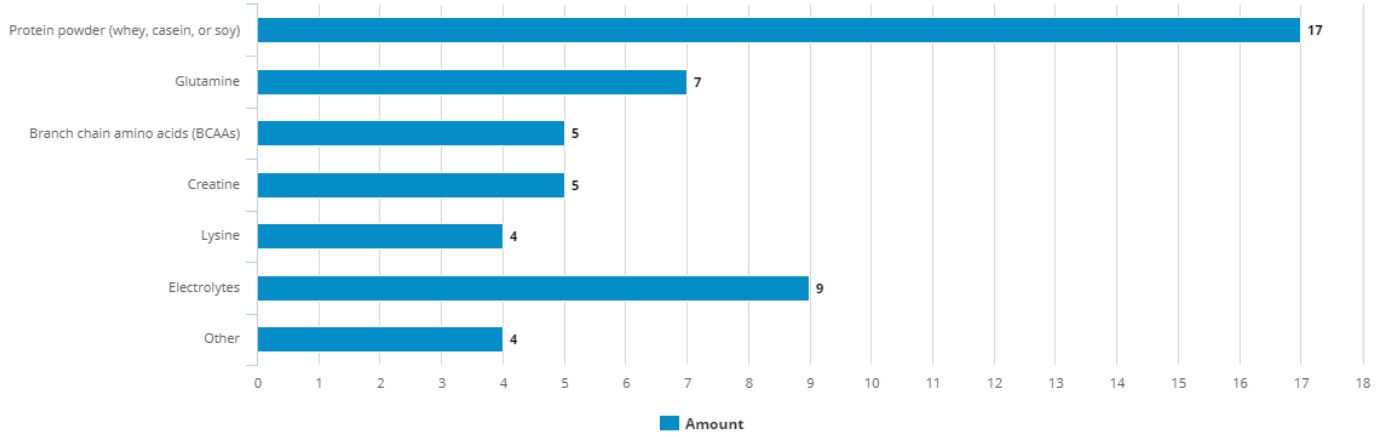
Number of responses: 23



8. What types of supplements or add-ins does your health club offer?
   Check all that apply
   a. Protein powder (whey, casein, or soy)
   b. Glutamine
   c. Branch chain amino acids (BCAAs)
   d. Creatine
   e. Lysine
   f. Electrolytes

8. What types of supplements or add-ins does your health club offer?

Number of responses: 22

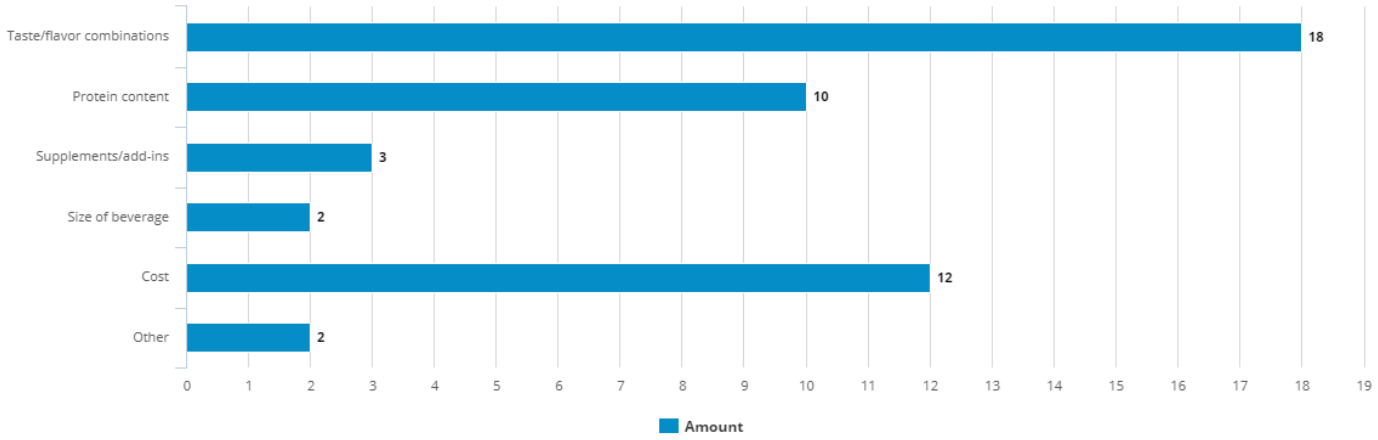


9. What are the two most important aspects of a smoothie you consider before purchasing? *Check two*
   a. Taste/flavor combinations
   b. Protein content
   c. Supplements/add-ins

d. Size of beverage
e. Cost
f. Something else _____

9. What are the two most important aspects of a smoothie you consider before purchasing?

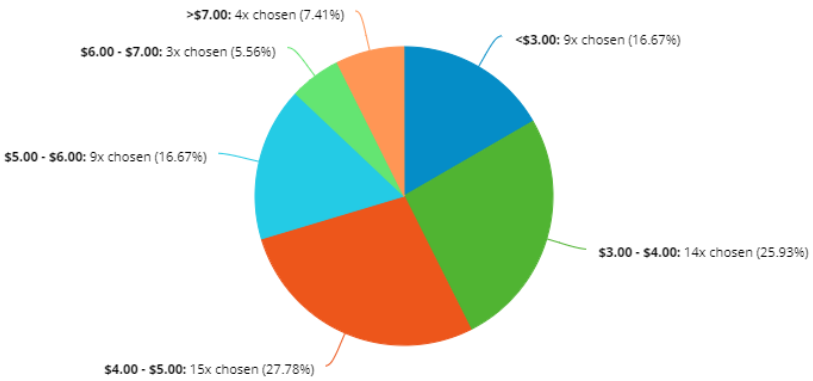
Number of responses: 26



10. What is the average price you pay for a smoothie at your gym (inclusive of all add-ins, supplements, etc.)?
If you do not purchase smoothies at a gym, or do not go to a gym with a smoothie bar, what is the price you would expect to pay?
a. <$3.00
b. $3.00 - $4.00
c. $4.00 - $5.00
d. $5.00 - $6.00
e. $6.00 - $7.00
f. >$7.00

10. What is the average price you pay for a smoothie at your gym (inclusive of all add-ins, supplements, etc.)?If you do not purchase smoothies at a gym, or do not go to a gym with a smoothie bar, what is the price you would expect to pay?

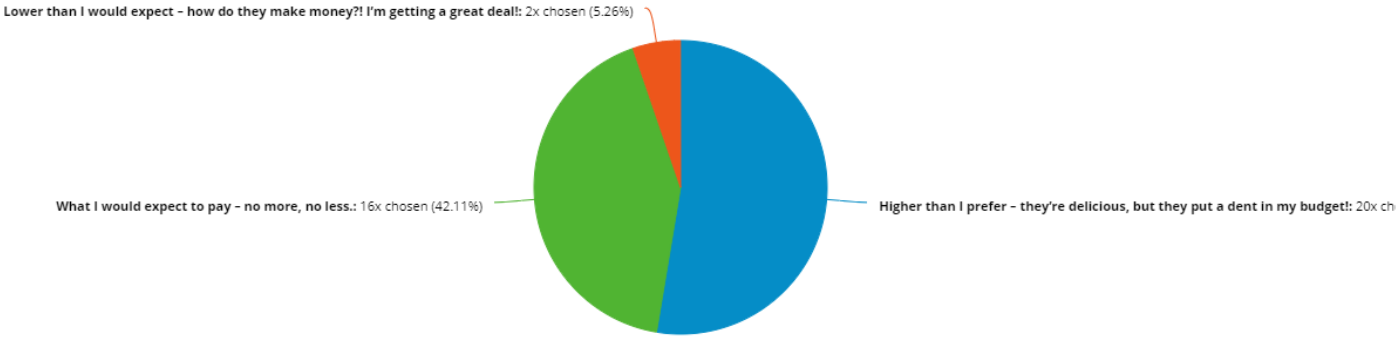
Number of responses: 54



11. If you do purchase beverages at your gym, would you say the price is higher than you would prefer, lower than you would expect, or roughly what you would expect to pay?
    a. Higher than I prefer – they're delicious, but they put a dent in my budget!
    b. What I would expect to pay – no more, no less
    c. Lower than I would expect – how do they make money?! I'm getting a great deal!

11. If you do purchase beverages at your gym, would you say the price is higher than you would prefer, lower than you would expect, or roughly what you would expect to pay?

Number of responses: 38



APPENDIX C

***SmoothieVend®* Menu**

BASE

- Cow's milk (shelf stable)
- Almond milk
- Coconut Milk
- Ice*

*ice can be used alone for a water-only base or in combination with any of the milks listed

WHEY PROTEIN FLAVORS*

- Chocolate
- Vanilla
- Peanut Butter
- Strawberry

**All proteins are whey proteins. While soy and casein are the other two most widely used proteins in supplements today, soy is a known allergen and pro-inflammatory agent for many people, while casein protein can trigger dairy allergies/intolerance in lactose intolerant customers.*

ORGANIC FRUITS*

- Strawberries
- Bananas
- Mangoes
- Blueberries
- Raspberries
- Pineapple
- Oranges

**All organic fruit will be blended frozen*

GREENS

As a boost to the fruit, protein and supplements that can be added to smoothies, Amazing Grass® Green SuperFood, is also available. One scoop of Amazing Grass contains a powerful blend of nutritious greens, phytonutrient-packed fruits, veggies and cereal grasses, digestive enzymes and probiotics.
https://www.amazinggrass.com/store/green-superfood-original.html

SUPPLEMENTS

- Glutamine
- Branch Chain Amino Acids
- Electrolytes
- Creatine
- Lysine
- Electrolyte blend

Don’t want to create your own blend? Enjoy one of these awesome SmoothieVend® beverage blends!

- Polka Dot Two-Piece - a blend of vanilla protein powder, raspberries and almond milk
- Crazy Bee - chocolate protein powder with pineapple and coconut milk
- Leapin’ Lizard - vanilla protein powder with blackberries and coconut milk
- Lunar Lemonade - your choice of protein powder with raspberries and your choice of milk
- Mediterranean Monster – strawberry protein powder, blueberries, and almond milk
- Pina Colada - vanilla protein powder with pineapple and coconut milk
- Strawberry Aphrodite - strawberry protein powder, banana, and almond milk
- Screamsicle - vanilla protein powder, oranges and your choice of milk